

June 19, 2026

H. Van Dyke Parunak
Editor, *Autonomous Agents and Multi-Agent Systems*
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cc: Prof. Stephen Cranefield, Dr. Shuyue Hu,
Prof. Bastin Tony Roy Savarimuthu, Dr. Surangika Ranathunga
Guest Editors, Special Issue: “When Foundation Models Meet Multi-Agent Systems”

Dear Dr Parunak,

Please find attached the revised manuscript and a point-by-point response for Submission ID f265ac80-65ad-483a-bcfc-21d010e52041, prepared in response to your decision of 22 April 2026 inviting major revision.

Reframing. The revision recasts the contribution as an instantiation of the symmetric-stigmergic schema you formalize in *Insects and Agents: Extending the Metaphor* (MABS25): foundation-model agents are deployed stigmergically, coordinating only through a shared artifact, and the paper maps each primitive of the schema, including the environment-to-agent arrow *ASU* that classic asymmetric stigmergy lacks, realized as band and model escalation when the field stalls. The method adopts the three-operator vocabulary (aggregate, propagate, evaporate) of *Agents, Pheromones, and Mean-Field Models* (AAMAS11), and the related work is rebuilt as a single lineage from digital pheromones to language-model agents.

Your points. The point-by-point response addresses each in turn. In brief: the novel terminology is dropped for pheromone and stigmergy vocabulary, and the title changes accordingly; pheromone propagation over the domain’s temporal structure (the *ESP* operator) is implemented in the kernel and ablated, answering the impoverished-structure concern directly; the manuscript is cut to 50 pages; the small problem scale is stated plainly as a limitation; and on accurate reporting, a code audit found a baseline system-prompt confound and a cross-strategy pressure-metric mismatch, both now fixed, so every result derives from a complete regenerated 1350-trial grid on one authoritative metric.

The work fits the special issue “When Foundation Models Meet Multi-Agent Systems” through a bidirectional mechanism: foundation models supply the open-ended actions classic stigmergy could not enumerate, and symmetric-stigmergic coordination supplies the pressure-based criterion that combines those proposals and escalates model capability.

Sincerely,

Rolando Rene Rodriguez, Jr.